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GitHub Link: <https://github.com/mehmetzahitavci/TrafficLights.git>

Introduction

The aim of our project is to design and implement a traffic management system using microprocessor logic. Our system gives provides real time interactivity through pedestrian request buttons and a visual countdown display. Key features include four-phase vehicle control, hardware-synced pedestrian signals, and a priority-based preemptive logic for night mode and pedestrian requests.

Circuit and Hardware Architecture

Master CPU (Vehicle Controller)

The Master CPU is the "brain" of the operation. It is connected to:

Port OA & OB: Control the signal states for North, South, East, and West vehicle lights.

Port OUT (04h): Drives the 7-segment Countdown Display, providing visual feedback to drivers.

Port IN (00h): Reads the system status. Bits 0-3 receive button data from the Slave CPU, while Bit 4 is directly connected to the Night Mode hardware switch for immediate override capability.

Slave CPU (Input Handler)

The Slave CPU's only responsibility is to poll the physical push-buttons (North, East, South, West). By letting our second CPU handle input polling the Master CPU is never "blocked" by mechanical bouncing or long input cycles, ensuring the timing of the traffic lights are precise and with minimum delay.

The communication between The Slave and Master CPU is governed by a Continuous State Polling mechanism.

Polling

The Slave CPU acts as dedicated buffer, it continuously scans the pedestrians, while The Master CPU polls input bits to check for both pedestrian button requests and a night-mode switch. This polling is integrated into the main state machine controlling the traffic phases as well as an internal countdown routine.

Pedestrian Integration

To handle pedestrian lights, we used simple and unique feature, connecting pedestrian light to the cross-wired vehicle signal. When turning right pedestrians have priority, depending on this logic we connected the pedestrian lights to the green lights on their left. This reduces code complexity, prevent conflicts even if we occur exception and if we are faced with code error our hardware handles the situation safely.

Software Implementation and Logic

Four-Phase State Machine

The software is structured as a Finite State Machine (FSM) consisting of four main phases (North, East, South, West). Each phase follows a strict sequence:

- 1.Green Phase: Master CPU sets the corresponding port bits and loads a 9-second duration.
- 2.Countdown: The COUNTDOWN_LOGIC routine updates the 7-segment display every second.
- 3.Yellow Transition: A SHORT_DELAY routine handles the transition to ensure safe braking distances before switching directions.

Smart Interruption & Decision Routing

1- The Masking System During each phase, the CPU uses a bit-mask (stored in Register H) to filter inputs. This allows the system to ignore buttons from the current green street while listening for requests from cross-streets.

2- Skip Logic: If a valid cross-street request is detected, the SKIP_TIMER routine immediately forces the countdown to zero. This accelerates the transition to the requested direction, reducing unnecessary wait times.

Night Mode

The master CPU monitors Bit 4 of the input port at the start of the every cycle and during all active countdown. If the Night Mode switch is activated the system jumps to NIGHT_MODE_ROUTINE. This bypasses the FSM, turns off the countdown display, and enters a loop where all yellow vehicle lights flash blink with delay routine. The system is remains in this state until the switch is deactivated, triggering the full system reset to ensure a safe restart.